JOHANNA ROTH

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Labor Economics
Secondary: Public and Urban Economics

REFERENCES

Professor Pierre Cahuc
Sciences Po
pierre.cahuc@sciencespo.fr

Professor Maria Guadalupe
INSEAD
maria.guadalupe@insead.edu

Professor Steven Raphael
University of California, Berkeley
stevenraphael@berkeley.edu

Professor Alexandra Roulet
INSEAD
alexandra.roulet@insead.edu

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2025– Research Associate, Stone Centre, INSEAD

EDUCATION

2022–2027 **PhD in Economics**, Sciences Po, Paris (expected completion: spring 2027)
- Advisor: Prof. Pierre Cahuc
- Thesis committee: Prof. Claire Montialoux, Prof. Roland Rathelot (CREST)
- Visiting Student, University of California, Berkeley, Spring 2025

2020–2022 **MPhil in Economics**, University of Oxford
- Awarded with Merit
- Distinction in MPhil thesis *The Impact of AI on Skill Demand – Evidence from Online Job Vacancies*, supervised by Prof. Abi Adams-Prassl

2016–2019 **BSc in Economics**, University of Mannheim
- Awarded with Distinction

PRE-DOCTORAL EXPERIENCE

2022 Research Assistant, Oxford Martin School, University of Oxford

2021–2022 Research Assistant, Centre for the Study of African Economies, University of Oxford

2021 Trainee, European Central Bank, DG Economics (Supply Side, Labour and Surveillance), Frankfurt

TEACHING

Fall 2024 Labor Economics and Employment Policies (Sciences Po Paris, Master)
Teaching Assistant for Prof. Stéphane Carcillo

Spring 2024 Statistics Advanced (Sciences Po Le Havre, Bachelor)
Lecturer

Fall 2023	Labor Economics (Sciences Po Paris, Bachelor) Teaching Assistant for Prof. Moshe Buchinsky
Spring 2023	Statistics Advanced (Sciences Po Le Havre, Bachelor) Lecturer

RESEARCH GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2025–2026	Pilot Funding, J-PAL European Social Inclusion Initiative (ESII), Round IV, PI [€29,000]
2024–2027	Research Grant, French Ministry of Labor (DARES), co-PI with Alexandra Roulet: *APR Évaluation préfigurative de la réforme France Travail* [€80,000]
2022–2025	Doctoral School Scholarship, Sciences Po
2021–2022	Haniel Scholarship, German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes) and Haniel Foundation
2017–2022	Scholarship, Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung

WORKING PAPERS

The Homelessness Trap: Labor Market Trajectories of Individuals Experiencing Homelessness — *Job Market Paper*

Job loss may push workers into homelessness, and homelessness may keep them out of work. I provide the first causal evidence on both directions, quantifying the risk of homelessness upon job loss and how much shelter access mitigates the negative impact of homelessness on labor market trajectories. To do so, I combine the universe of shelter requests with administrative employment and unemployment insurance records in France. To identify each direction, I use a matched difference-in-differences design around economic layoffs and an instrumental variables design based on the leniency of call center agents allocating shelter. Losing a job raises the risk of homelessness by 50 percent. Getting a shelter bed at the first request cuts job loss by 26 percent for those still working and raises employment a year later by 58 percent for the unemployed. This evidence suggests that homelessness is an uninsured risk of unemployment for low-skilled workers. In turn, rapid shelter access can partly mitigate its negative consequences for employment.

Which Soft Skills Matter, and Which Can Be Trained? Experimental Evidence from Job Seekers (with Maria Guadalupe and Alexandra Roulet)

Which soft skills both matter for finding a job and can be trained in adulthood? In baseline data on 52,352 French job seekers, we show that personality traits and job-search self-efficacy both predict job finding and earnings, and self-efficacy further predicts finding open-ended instead of fixed-term jobs. A randomized evaluation of a one-to-two-week soft-skills training run by the public employment service then shows that self-efficacy is malleable while traits are not: the program raises self-efficacy by 0.57 standard deviations and leaves the Big Five and locus of control unchanged. Participants shift from fixed-term to open-ended contracts, raising their employment rate in open-ended jobs by 8.6 percentage points over six months, on a base of 9.6 percent. Further analysis suggest that search effort and search criteria are not the main driver, in fact they are not affected, instead the increase in soft skills seems to lead to a higher success per application.

Reaching Marginalized Job Seekers through Public Employment Services: Experimental Evidence from Ethiopia (with Morgan Hardy, Christian Meyer and Marc Witte; IZA DP No. 18005)

We experimentally evaluate an at-scale expansion of public employment services in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, that provided up-to-date vacancy information through local offices. Benefits were concentrated among relatively lower-skill women (LSW), the most marginalized job seekers before the expansion: offers and wage employment rose, work in household enterprises fell, and earnings increased by 24 percent. Impacts exceeded what the listed vacancies could explain; instead, LSW changed expectations and aspirations. Job match quality also increased. Notably, LSW job offers arrived through friends and family, not through the service directly – evidence that social networks can carry information to those hardest to reach.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Housing or Employment First? Experimental Evidence from a Job Search Assistance Program for Homeless Job Seekers – *RCT funded by J-PAL ESII; pilot in the field*
- Trajectories and Targeting of Job Seekers and Social Minima Benefit Receivers (with Alexandra Roulet) – *RCT funded by the French Ministry of Labor; pilot in the field*
- Inflows and Outflows out of Homelessness (with Christophe Bruneel-Zupanc, Alexandre Gaillard, Christian Hellwig and Nicolas Werquin)
- Housing and School Disruptions: The Effects on Unhoused Kids (with Sydney Costantini)
- A Job Search Model Where Housing Matters (with Kerstin Holzheu)
- Financial Literacy and Well-Being (with Mark Stabile)

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026	Sciences Po internal seminar, Leuven Summer Event, 2nd PhD Conference in Labor and Behavioral Economics, SIOE, Organizational Economics Summer Symposium, EEA, IIPF, EALE, VfS Annual Conference, Inaugural IZA@LISER Conference in Labour Economics (scheduled)
2025	Berkeley IRLE Seminar, IZA 1st PhD Conference in Labor and Behavioral Economics, SOLE – Joint World Labor Conference, EEA Annual Congress, Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar, World Bank–KDI 6th Development Impact Conference, INSEAD Brownbag Seminar
2024	INSEAD Brownbag Seminar, Jobs and Development Conference, Sciences Po Departmental Seminar, Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar
2023	Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar
2022	TASKS IV: The Digital and Ecological Transformation of the Labour Market (International BIBB/IAB/ZEW Conference)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Co-organizer, Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar (2023–2026)
Referee for *LABOUR: Review of Labour Economics and Industrial Relations*

SKILLS

Languages	German (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)
Programming	Stata, Python, R, SAS

Last updated: November 2026